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AQA GCSE Geography (8035) — Paper 2: Challenges in the Human Environment · 3.2.2 The Changing Economic World

2.3 The Changing Economic World

1. Defining Development

Development refers to improvements in the standard of living and quality of life for people within a country. It is measured across two broad dimensions:

- **Economic development** — growth in wealth, industrialisation, trade, and GDP per capita.
- **Human development** — improvements in quality of life: health, education, wellbeing, and political freedom.

Development is best understood as a **continuum** — a sliding scale from the least to most developed — rather than a binary division of "developed" and "developing" worlds. Countries sit at different points on this continuum and move along it over time.

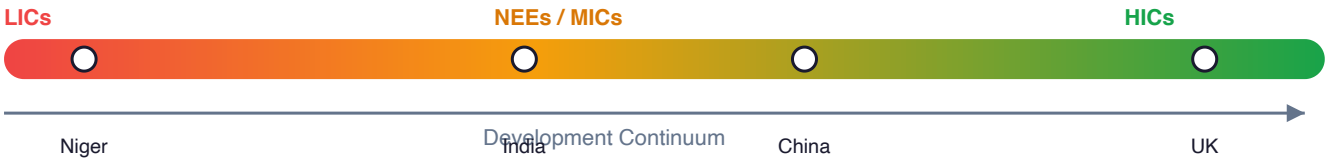
Classification of Countries

HICs (High Income Countries) — GNI per capita above ~$13,900 (World Bank threshold, 2025). Examples: USA, UK, Germany, Japan, Australia.

LICs (Low Income Countries) — GNI per capita below ~$1,135 (2025). Examples: Niger, South Sudan, DR Congo, Afghanistan.

NEEs (Newly Emerging Economies) — Countries rapidly industrialising and growing, often moving from LIC/MIC status. Examples: China, India, Brazil, Nigeria, Mexico, Indonesia, Turkey, South Africa.

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Exam Tip: Avoid using the terms "first world / third world" or "developed / developing" in exam answers — they imply a binary and are outdated. Use HIC, LIC, NEE, or "more/less economically developed country" (MEDC/LEDC). Examiners reward precise terminology.

2. Measuring Development

Development can be measured using **single indicators** (one measure) or **composite indicators** (combining multiple measures).

Single Indicators

Indicator	What It Measures	Advantage	Limitation
GNI per capita (US$)	Average wealth per person (Gross National Income / population)	Easy to compare internationally	Ignores inequality (distribution of wealth)
Birth rate (per 1,000)	Number of live births per 1,000 people per year	Indicates healthcare, education level	Affected by age structure of population
Death rate (per 1,000)	Number of deaths per 1,000 people per year	Reflects healthcare quality	HICs can have high death rates due to ageing population
Infant mortality rate (per 1,000)	Deaths of children under 1 year per 1,000 live births	Very sensitive indicator — falls quickly with development	May not reflect adult quality of life
Life expectancy (years)	Average expected lifespan at birth	Reflects healthcare, nutrition, safety	Averages hide internal inequalities

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Literacy rate (%)	% of adults who can read and write	Shows educational access	Doesn't measure quality of education
Access to clean water (%)	% of population with safe water supply	Directly linked to health outcomes	Data can be unreliable in LICs
Calorie intake (per day)	Average daily calories consumed per person	Indicates food security and nutrition	Doesn't distinguish between nutritious/non-nutritious calories

Composite Indicator: Human Development Index (HDI)

HDI (Human Development Index) — developed by the UNDP, combines three dimensions into a score between 0 and 1:

1. **GNI per capita** (economic dimension)
2. **Life expectancy at birth** (health dimension)
3. **Mean years of schooling + expected years of schooling** (education dimension)

Country	HDI Score (2022)	Category	GNI per capita (PPP US$)	Life Expectancy
Norway	0.966	Very High	$82,500	83.2 years
UK	0.940	Very High	$45,225	81.3 years
China	0.788	High	$19,590	78.2 years
India	0.644	Medium	$7,420	67.7 years
Ghana	0.602	Medium	$5,269	64.1 years
Niger	0.394	Low	$1,284	62.4 years

Advantages of HDI: more rounded than single indicators; recognises that development is multidimensional; widely used for international comparison.

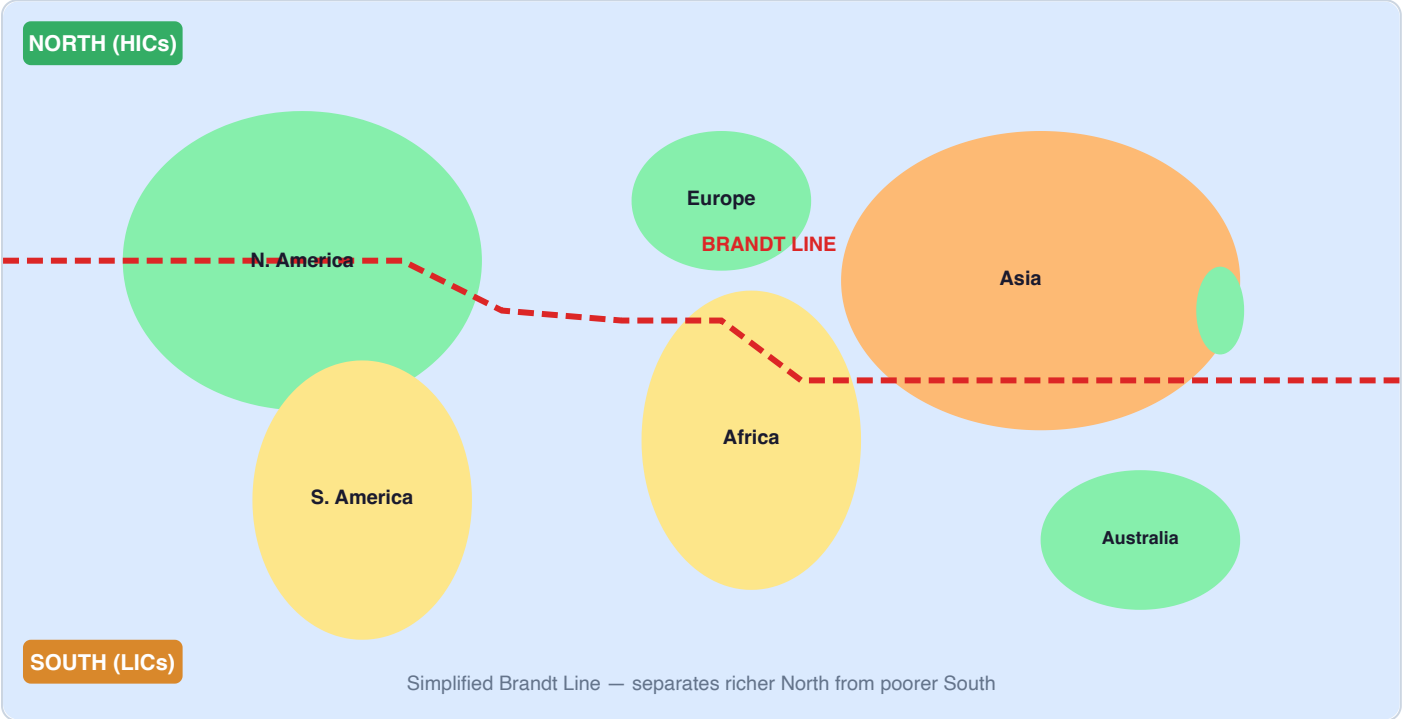
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Limitations of HDI: still doesn't capture inequality within countries; ignores environmental sustainability; ignores gender inequality, political freedom, happiness.

> **Exam Tip:** The infant mortality rate is considered the most "sensitive" single indicator because it responds quickly to improvements in development (healthcare, sanitation, nutrition). Mention this in evaluation questions about measuring development.

3. Patterns of Development

Wealth and development are unevenly distributed globally. A broad pattern is visible in the **North-South divide**, summarised by the **Brandt Line**.



Simplified Brandt Line — separates richer North from poorer South

Key patterns of global wealth distribution:

- HICs are concentrated in North America, Western Europe, Japan, and Australia/NZ.
- LICs are concentrated in sub-Saharan Africa and parts of South/Southeast Asia.
- Sub-Saharan Africa has the highest concentration of the world's LICs.
- NEEs — the BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa) and MINT (Mexico, Indonesia, Nigeria, Turkey) — are rapidly changing the global economic landscape.

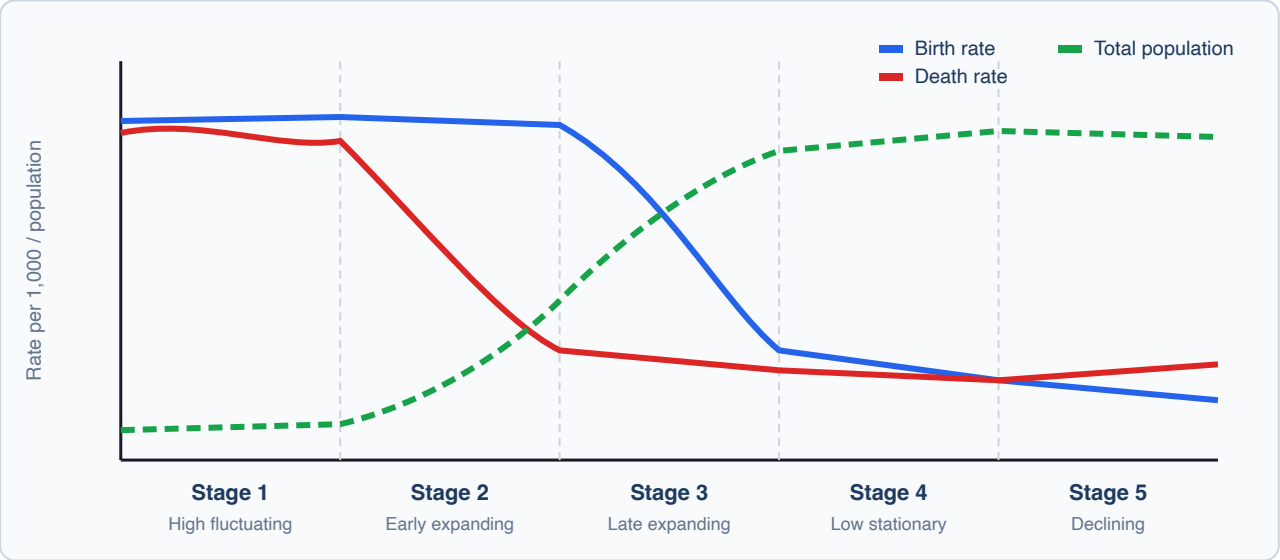
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- The Brandt Line is a simplification: Australia and New Zealand are geographically south but economically "north".

> **Exam Tip:** The Brandt Line is a useful concept but always note its limitations — it oversimplifies a complex spectrum. Australia and NZ are exceptions. Many NEEs are in the "south" but are growing rapidly.

4. The Demographic Transition Model (DTM)

The DTM shows how a country's **birth rate**, **death rate** and **total population** change over time as it develops.



Stage	Birth rate	Death rate	Population	Reasons	Example
1	High	High, fluctuating	Low, stable	No birth control; children needed for farm work; disease, famine and poor healthcare	A few remote tribes today
2	High	Falling rapidly	Rising rapidly	Improvements in healthcare, clean water, sanitation and food supply; birth rate stays high through tradition	Niger, Afghanistan

3	Falling rapidly	Falling more slowly	Rising more slowly	Contraception available; women educated and working; fewer children needed as infant mortality falls	India, Brazil, Nigeria (late stage 2/3)
4	Low	Low	High, stable	Family planning widespread; children expensive; good healthcare	UK, USA
5	Very low	Low, rising slightly	Slowly falling	Ageing population; people having children later or not at all	Japan, Italy, Germany

Exam Tip: The DTM links directly to development — LICs tend to be in stages 2–3, NEEs in stage 3, and HICs in stages 4–5. A limitation is that it is based on the experience of European countries and assumes all countries will follow the same path.

5. Causes of Uneven Development

Uneven development has multiple, interrelated causes — both physical and human.

Physical Causes

- **Landlocked countries** — no access to sea trade routes, making trade expensive (Mali, Chad, Zambia). 16 of the world's 32 landlocked developing countries are in Africa.
- **Tropical climate** — high temperatures and humidity increase prevalence of diseases (malaria, dengue) which reduce workforce productivity. Seasonal droughts reduce agricultural output.
- **Natural hazards** — frequent earthquakes, floods, cyclones destroy infrastructure and divert development funds to disaster relief (Haiti, Bangladesh).
- **Lack of natural resources** — limited mineral or energy wealth restricts income generation. However, the "resource curse" shows that over-reliance on a single resource (e.g. oil in Nigeria) can actually worsen inequality if wealth is poorly distributed.

Human Causes

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- **Colonialism** — European powers extracted resources, cash crops, and labour from colonies for centuries. Infrastructure built to serve colonial export needs, not local development. Borders drawn arbitrarily, ignoring ethnic groups, causing post-independence conflict.
- **Trade inequality** — "Terms of trade" work against LICs. LICs export primary commodities (cocoa, coffee, copper) at volatile, low prices; import manufactured goods at higher prices. "Commodity trap" — prices set by global markets, not producers.
- **Debt** — Many LICs borrowed heavily in the 1970s-80s for development; interest repayments now exceed incoming aid. World Bank and IMF Structural Adjustment Programmes (SAPs) required cuts to health/education spending — worsening development.
- **Political instability** — corruption diverts funds; civil war destroys infrastructure and displaces populations. South Sudan — world's youngest nation — suffered civil war from 2013 to 2018 and continuing instability since, preventing development. Conflict deters foreign investment.
- **Poor governance** — weak institutions, lack of rule of law, and corruption reduce effectiveness of development spending.

Exam Tip: "Explain why development is uneven" questions require you to state, explain, and link multiple causes. Don't just list them — explain the mechanism (e.g. "landlocked countries face higher transport costs, which makes imports more expensive and reduces trade, slowing economic growth").

6. Consequences of Uneven Development

Consequence	Detail
Disparities in wealth	The richest 10% of the world's population hold around three-quarters of global wealth. GNI per capita in the UK is over 40 times that of Malawi.
Disparities in health	Life expectancy is about 81 in the UK but under 55 in Nigeria and Chad. Infant mortality in Sierra Leone is roughly 20 times that of Japan. Lack of clean water and healthcare means diseases such as malaria and cholera remain common in LICs.

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International migration	People migrate from poorer to richer countries for jobs, higher wages and safety — economic migrants (e.g. from Eastern Europe to the UK) and refugees fleeing conflict. Remittances sent home can be a major source of income for LICs.

7. Trade and Development

International trade is a major driver of development — but access to trade and its terms are unequal.

Fairtrade

> **Fairtrade** — a trading partnership that ensures producers in LICs receive a guaranteed minimum price for their goods, plus a "Fairtrade Premium" (extra money for community projects). Managed by the Fairtrade Foundation. Nearly 2 million farmers and workers in around 70 countries. Products include cocoa, coffee, bananas, cotton, gold.

- **Benefits:** stable income, social premium for schools/wells/healthcare, empowers smallholder farmers, encourages environmental standards.
- **Criticisms:** only a small fraction of the Fairtrade price reaches farmers; consumers pay more but benefit may be limited; not all large-scale producers can access Fairtrade certification.

Trade Blocs and the WTO

- **Trade blocs** (e.g. EU single market, NAFTA/USMCA) reduce tariffs between member countries — benefitting members but excluding LICs.
- **WTO (World Trade Organisation)** — sets global trade rules. Accused of favouring HIC agendas; agricultural subsidies in the EU/USA undercut LIC farmers.

Commodity Dependence

- **Ghana** — heavily dependent on cocoa and gold exports. When cocoa prices fall, government revenue falls sharply.
- **Nigeria** — oil accounts for ~90% of export revenue and ~70% of government income. The "Dutch Disease": oil wealth causes the currency to rise, making other exports uncompetitive and damaging manufacturing.

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8. Aid

Aid is the transfer of resources (money, goods, expertise) from one country or organisation to another, usually to help development or respond to a crisis.

Types of Aid

Type	Description	Example
Bilateral aid	Government to government, often with political strings attached ("tied aid")	UK aid to Pakistan (FCDO)
Multilateral aid	Channelled through international organisations (UN, World Bank, IMF)	World Bank infrastructure loans
NGO aid	Non-governmental organisations funded by voluntary donations	Oxfam, Red Cross, WaterAid
Emergency/short-term aid	Rapid response to disasters — food, shelter, medicine	Nepal earthquake 2015 response
Long-term/development aid	Building infrastructure, improving education, strengthening institutions	WaterAid installing clean water systems

Tied Aid

Tied aid — aid with conditions: recipient country must spend the money on goods/services from the donor country. Critics argue this benefits donor economies more than recipients.

Aid Debate

Arguments FOR aid	Arguments AGAINST aid
Saves lives in emergency situations	Can create dependency — countries rely on aid rather than developing own economies

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Funds education and healthcare that governments cannot afford	Tied aid benefits donor country companies, not recipients
Builds essential infrastructure (roads, dams, schools)	Corruption diverts aid funds away from intended recipients
Transfers technology and expertise	Inappropriate technology may not suit local conditions or skills
Helps rebuild after natural disasters	Aid can suppress local agricultural markets (food aid undercuts local farmers)

Exam Tip: When evaluating aid, use the phrase "sustainable development" — the most effective aid builds local capacity rather than creating dependency. Long-term development aid is generally considered more beneficial than emergency aid in the longer term.

9. Other Strategies to Reduce Inequality

Microfinance / Microcredit

Microfinance — small loans (micro-loans) given to individuals (often women) in LICs to start or grow small businesses, without requiring collateral. Developed by the Grameen Bank in Bangladesh (founded 1983 by Muhammad Yunus). Over 9 million borrowers, 97% women. Average loan ~$200. Success rate high: ~98% repayment.

Benefits: empowers women, breaks poverty cycle, stimulates local economy, does not create national debt.
Criticisms: high interest rates in some schemes, small scale — cannot address systemic inequality.

Debt Relief

The **HIPC (Heavily Indebted Poor Countries) initiative** — IMF/World Bank programme that cancelled around $76 billion of debt for over 35 qualifying countries. Freed up government funds for health and

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education spending (Mozambique, Uganda, Bolivia). Conditions applied — some argue these conditions still favour creditor countries.

Intermediate/Appropriate Technology

> **Appropriate technology** — technology that is suited to the local environment, skills, culture, and economic circumstances of the community. Often simple, low-cost, repairable locally. Championed by NGO Practical Action (formerly ITDG).

- Wind pumps for irrigation (Kenya) — no fuel needed, maintained locally.
- Solar cookers (India) — reduce firewood use, improve health (less indoor smoke).
- Biosand filters (Cambodia) — clean water at low cost.
- Treadle pumps (Bangladesh) — foot-powered irrigation for small farmers.

Tourism

Tourism brings foreign exchange to LICs and NEEs. **Kenya** — safari and beach tourism earns billions of dollars a year, creating jobs in rural areas. **Maldives** — ~28% of GDP from tourism. However: leakage (profits leaving to TNC-owned hotels in HICs), environmental damage (reef degradation), seasonality of income, vulnerability to global events (COVID-19 devastated Maldives tourism).

Export Processing Zones (EPZs)

EPZs are designated areas where companies pay reduced taxes and have relaxed regulations to attract foreign investment and manufacturing. China used EPZs (Shenzhen Special Economic Zone from 1980) as a key driver of rapid industrialisation and export growth.

10. Case Study: Tourism in Jamaica (Reducing the Development Gap)

Tourism in Jamaica, an upper-middle-income Caribbean country

- Jamaica is an island in the Caribbean with a tropical climate, beaches, coral reefs, the Blue Mountains, waterfalls (Dunn's River Falls) and a rich musical culture (reggae, Bob Marley).

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- It receives over **4 million visitors a year** (stay-over and cruise visitors combined) — mainly from the USA, Canada and the UK.
- Tourism contributes around **30% of GDP** (direct and indirect) and employs over 200,000 people, roughly a fifth of all jobs.

Benefits:

- Foreign exchange income and taxes help pay for infrastructure — new roads (e.g. the Highway 2000 network), airport upgrades and water supply.
- Jobs in hotels, restaurants, transport and tour guiding; the **multiplier effect** supports farmers, fishermen and craft producers.
- Raises the international profile of Jamaica and encourages investment.

Problems:

- Many jobs are seasonal and low-paid; many resorts are foreign-owned, so profits leak overseas (**economic leakage**). "All-inclusive" resorts mean tourists spend little money in local businesses.
- Environmental damage — coral reef damage, beach erosion, waste and water shortages near resorts.
- A gap between wealthy tourist enclaves and nearby poor communities; vulnerability to hurricanes and global recessions (tourism collapsed during the 2020 pandemic).

Evaluation: Tourism has helped Jamaica's economy grow and reduced the development gap to some extent, but it depends on keeping leakage low and spreading benefits to local people — e.g. through community-based ecotourism in the Blue Mountains and Cockpit Country.

11. Case Study: Nigeria — A Newly Emerging Economy

Nigeria — location and importance

- Nigeria is in **West Africa**, on the Gulf of Guinea, bordered by Benin, Niger, Chad and Cameroon.
- It has the **largest population in Africa** — over 220 million — and one of its largest economies.

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- It is a major oil producer and a member of OPEC; its film (Nollywood) and music industries are influential across Africa and beyond.
- Nigeria contributes peacekeeping troops to the UN and African Union and is a leading member of ECOWAS (the Economic Community of West African States).

Wider political, social, cultural and environmental context

- **Political:** a former British colony (independent in 1960); civil war (1967–70) and long periods of military rule, with democratic civilian government since 1999. Insurgency by Boko Haram in the north-east has displaced millions.
- **Social and cultural:** over 250 ethnic groups (largest: Hausa-Fulani, Yoruba and Igbo); the north is mainly Muslim and the south mainly Christian.
- **Environmental:** a range of environments, from semi-arid savanna in the north (prone to desertification) through tropical forest to the Niger Delta's mangroves and swamps in the south.

Changing industrial structure

Sector	Change
Primary (farming, oil)	Agriculture still employs about a third of workers, but its share of GDP has fallen to around 20–25%. Oil makes up around 90% of exports but under 10% of GDP.
Secondary (manufacturing)	Growing slowly — food processing, cement (Dangote Cement), vehicle assembly, textiles. Manufacturing creates more reliable jobs and multiplier effects.
Tertiary and quaternary (services)	Now over half of GDP — banking, telecommunications (MTN, Airtel), retail, film and IT. Lagos is a growing tech hub.

The role of transnational corporations (TNCs)

Advantages	Disadvantages

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Shell and other oil companies have invested billions of dollars and pay large sums in taxes and royalties.	Oil spills in the Niger Delta have polluted farmland, creeks and drinking water. Gas flaring releases CO_2 and toxic gases.
Unilever (in Nigeria since the 1920s) employs over 1,000 people directly and supports thousands more in its supply chain.	Profits often go back to HICs; local firms struggle to compete.
TNCs bring technology, skills training and infrastructure such as roads and power supplies.	Some TNCs have been accused of poor working conditions and of benefiting from corruption.

Changing political and trading relationships

- Historically, trade was mainly with the UK and Europe. Today Nigeria's main trading partners include **China** (its largest source of imports), India, the USA and the Netherlands.
- China has invested heavily in infrastructure — railways (Lagos–Ibadan, Abuja–Kaduna), the Lekki Deep Sea Port and roads — often in return for access to oil and other resources.
- Nigeria joined the **African Continental Free Trade Area** (AfCFTA), aiming to increase trade within Africa.

International aid

- Nigeria receives aid for health, education and humanitarian needs — e.g. UK and US funding for malaria nets and vaccination; Gavi and the WHO's role in eradicating wild polio (Africa was declared free of wild polio in 2020).
- Aid has improved health outcomes, but corruption has sometimes meant that money does not reach those it was intended for.

Environmental impacts of economic development

- **Oil spills** in the Niger Delta — thousands of spills since the 1970s have destroyed fisheries and mangroves.
- **Air and water pollution** from industry, traffic and waste in Lagos; illegal dumping of toxic waste.
- **Deforestation** for farming, logging and fuelwood — Nigeria has lost a large share of its original forest.
- **Desertification** in the north, worsened by overgrazing.

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Effects of economic development on quality of life

- **Improvements:** life expectancy has risen (from about 46 in 2000 to around 54 today); more access to safe water, mobile phones and the internet; a growing middle class.
- **Limits:** wealth is very unequal — tens of millions of Nigerians live in extreme poverty, more than in almost any other country; unreliable electricity; high youth unemployment.

Exam Tip: The NEE case study is often tested with 9-mark "Evaluate the role of TNCs" or "To what extent has economic development improved quality of life?" questions. Always balance positives and negatives with Nigerian evidence and finish with a clear judgement.

12. Globalisation and Development

Globalisation — the increasing interconnectedness of the world through trade, investment, migration, and communications.

Transnational Corporations (TNCs)

TNCs (Transnational Corporations) — companies that operate in multiple countries. Examples: Nike, Apple, Shell, Unilever, Samsung. They locate headquarters in HICs but manufacturing in LICs/NEEs to exploit lower labour costs, tax advantages, and weaker regulations.

Positive impacts on LICs/NEEs	Negative impacts on LICs/NEEs
Creates employment (often thousands of jobs)	Low wages — often close to minimum; poor working conditions
Technology transfer to local workers and firms	Profits repatriated back to HIC headquarters — "leakage"
Brings Foreign Direct Investment (FDI)	Environmental damage — weaker regulations exploited
Develops infrastructure (roads, ports)	Worker exploitation — long hours, unsafe conditions (Rana Plaza, Bangladesh 2013)

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Increases exports and government tax revenue	Undermines local industries through competition

The Global Shift

Since the 1970s–80s, manufacturing has shifted from HICs (USA, UK, Germany) to NEEs and LICs (China, Vietnam, Bangladesh, Mexico). This "global shift" has brought rapid industrialisation to Asia in particular, reducing absolute poverty for hundreds of millions of people. However, it has also led to deindustrialisation and job losses in traditional manufacturing regions of HICs (e.g. Rust Belt, USA; steel towns in Wales/NE England).

Exam Tip: For TNC evaluation questions, structure your answer around: economic impacts (jobs, FDI, tax), social impacts (working conditions, urbanisation), and environmental impacts. Use a named TNC with specific details — Nike in Vietnam, or Apple's Foxconn factories in China — to access top marks.

13. Economic Futures in the UK — Causes of Change

Cause	Explanation
Deindustrialisation	The decline of traditional industries such as coal mining, steel, shipbuilding and textiles from the 1960s onwards. Coal mining employed around a million people in the 1920s; by 2015 the last deep coal mine (Kellingley) had closed. Causes: cheaper imports, exhaustion of resources, mechanisation.
Globalisation	Manufacturing moved to countries with lower labour costs (the global shift); the UK specialised in services, finance and high-tech industries instead.
Government policies	Privatisation and the closure of state-owned industries in the 1980s; later investment in regeneration, enterprise zones, the Northern Powerhouse and "levelling up". Membership and then departure from the EU (2020) changed trade relationships.

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14. The UK's Post-Industrial Economy

Post-industrial economy — an economy in which most people work in the tertiary (services) and quaternary (knowledge, research and IT) sectors rather than in manufacturing. Over 80% of UK jobs are now in services.

- **Information technology:** software, digital and tech companies — London's "Tech City" (Shoreditch), Manchester, Cambridge.
- **Service industries:** retail, tourism, health, education.
- **Finance:** the City of London and Canary Wharf, Edinburgh and Leeds — financial services contribute around 8–9% of UK economic output.
- **Research:** universities and research institutes, pharmaceutical and biotechnology firms.

Science and business parks — Cambridge Science Park

- Founded by Trinity College in 1970 — the oldest science park in the UK. It is home to over 100 companies employing about 7,000 people, mainly in biotechnology, IT and research.
- Location factors: links with Cambridge University research and graduates; access to the M11 and A14 and to Stansted airport; an attractive environment.
- It is part of "Silicon Fen", the cluster of high-tech firms around Cambridge.

Environmental impact of industry — Torr Quarry, Somerset

- Torr Quarry, near Frome, is one of the UK's largest limestone quarries, supplying crushed rock for roads and construction.
- **Impacts:** visual scarring, noise, dust and heavy lorry traffic; loss of habitats.
- **Making it more sustainable:** about 75% of the stone leaves by rail rather than road; screening banks and tree planting hide the quarry; the quarry floor is being restored as lakes and wildlife habitats; blasting is limited to set times.

15. Social and Economic Changes in the Rural Landscape

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	Population growth — South Cambridgeshire	Population decline — the Outer Hebrides
Why?	Commuters and workers attracted by jobs in Cambridge's high-tech economy; good transport links	Remote islands off north-west Scotland; limited jobs (crofting, fishing, tourism); young people leave for education and work
Social effects	House prices rise beyond the reach of local young people; villages become commuter dormitories; new housing estates (e.g. Northstowe new town)	Ageing population; schools and shops close; Gaelic culture under pressure
Economic effects	Traffic congestion on roads into Cambridge; demand for new infrastructure; services such as schools may be overstretched	Fewer workers and customers make services and businesses unviable; reliance on ferries and subsidies

16. Improvements to Transport Infrastructure

- **Roads:** "smart motorways" using the hard shoulder as a running lane (now paused for new schemes over safety concerns); upgrades to routes such as the A14 Cambridge–Huntingdon.
- **Rail:** the Elizabeth line (Crossrail) across London opened in 2022. HS2 Phase 1 (London–Birmingham) is under construction, though the northern legs were cancelled in 2023. Northern rail electrification and TransPennine upgrades aim to improve links between northern cities.
- **Ports:** Liverpool2 deep-water container terminal; London Gateway port on the Thames estuary.
- **Airports:** Heathrow is close to capacity; a third runway has long been proposed and remains controversial because of noise, air pollution and climate concerns.

17. The North–South Divide

- The UK has an economic divide between the more prosperous **South East** (especially London) and parts of the **North, Midlands, Wales and Northern Ireland**, which were hit harder by deindustrialisation.

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- Differences include wages, house prices, life expectancy, educational results and unemployment. London's output per head is around 1.7 times the UK average.

Strategies to resolve regional differences

- **Northern Powerhouse** (from 2014) — investment in transport, science and innovation in northern cities.
- **Devolution** — powers and budgets given to elected mayors (e.g. Greater Manchester, West Midlands) and to Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.
- **Enterprise zones and freeports** — tax breaks and simpler planning to attract businesses to struggling areas.
- **Levelling up funds** — money for town centres, transport and regeneration in poorer areas; moving some government jobs out of London (e.g. Treasury campus in Darlington).

18. The UK's Place in the Wider World

- **Trade:** major trading partners include the EU (still the largest overall), the USA and China. Since leaving the EU, the UK has signed new trade deals (e.g. with Australia and New Zealand) and joined the CPTPP trade bloc (2024).
- **Culture:** a global influence through the English language, music, film, sport (the Premier League is watched worldwide) and the BBC.
- **Transport:** Heathrow is a global hub; the Channel Tunnel links the UK to mainland Europe.
- **Electronic communication:** undersea cables connect the UK to North America and Europe, making London a key centre for global data and finance.
- **The Commonwealth and international organisations:** the UK is a member of the Commonwealth (56 countries), the G7, G20, NATO and a permanent member of the UN Security Council.

Exam Tip: Questions on the UK economy often ask you to "use a named example" — Cambridge Science Park, Torr Quarry, South Cambridgeshire and the Outer Hebrides give you specific, memorable evidence to quote.

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